



Would You Rather? • Real-Life Career Decisions

Career Exploration • choices with actual tradeoffs

FOR STAFF • 30-MINUTE SESSION

Purpose: Move beyond basic preference questions by comparing pay, schedule, commute, training, and job conditions.

Materials: This packet; calculator optional.

Easy flow: 5 min explain tradeoffs • 20 min choose/defend 6 scenarios • 5 min reflection.

Decision 1

A • JOB A: \$16.50/hr, 35 hrs/week, 5-minute drive, evenings/weekends.

B • JOB B: \$18.75/hr, 28 hrs/week, 40-minute drive, Monday-Friday.

My choice: A / B Most important reason: _____

One question I would ask before deciding: _____

Decision 2

A • JOB A: \$14/hr with paid training and a clear promotion path.

B • JOB B: \$17/hr temporary job with no guaranteed hours next month.

My choice: A / B Most important reason: _____

One question I would ask before deciding: _____

Decision 3

A • JOB A: Indoor office, repetitive tasks, predictable schedule.

B • JOB B: Outdoor crew, changing tasks, weather affects schedule.

My choice: A / B Most important reason: _____

One question I would ask before deciding: _____

Decision 4

A • JOB A: 7 AM start and off by 3 PM.

B • JOB B: 11 AM start and off by 7 PM.

My choice: A / B Most important reason: _____

One question I would ask before deciding: _____

Decision 5

A • JOB A: Lower pay but health insurance and paid time off.

B • JOB B: \$2 more per hour but no benefits.

My choice: A / B Most important reason: _____

One question I would ask before deciding: _____

Decision 6

A • JOB A: Job you enjoy but requires a 1-year certificate.

B • JOB B: Job you can start tomorrow but do not see yourself doing long-term.

My choice: A / B Most important reason: _____

One question I would ask before deciding: _____

Decision 7

A • JOB A: Supervisor gives lots of feedback and checks your work.

B • JOB B: Supervisor expects you to work independently after training.

My choice: A / B Most important reason: _____

One question I would ask before deciding: _____

Decision 8

A • JOB A: 20 hours/week while finishing school.

B • JOB B: 38 hours/week but less time for schoolwork.

My choice: A / B Most important reason: _____

One question I would ask before deciding: _____

Wrap-Up • Get Them Talking

☹ Did the highest-paying option always win? Why or why not?

☹ Which matters most to you right now: money, schedule, distance, benefits, or enjoyment?

💬 What could change your priorities five years from now?
